



East Lansing High School Science Olympiad Club Bylaws

Last Ratified: DATE

SIGNATURES:

ARTICLE I: PURPOSE & MISSION

The East Lansing High School Science Olympiad Club (ELHS SOC) is dedicated to fostering a passion for science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM) through rigorous academic and hands-on engineering competition. The club aims to provide a supportive, collaborative, and fun educational environment that encourages teamwork, integrity, and academic excellence.

ARTICLE II: MEMBERSHIP & EXPECTATIONS

Section 1: General Membership Requirements

- **Good Standing:** Members must regularly attend weekly club meetings and consistently log required study hours. Members will not be considered in good standing during the academic year if they have not attended a meeting or have not submitted study hours in the past month and will have to remedy with a head coach.
- **Communication:** Members are required to check their school email and designated team communication chats regularly to stay updated on schedules and announcements.
- **Partner Accountability:** Science Olympiad is a team effort. Members must meet with their event partners outside of regular club meetings to study, build, or practice. Persistent failure to coordinate with partners is grounds for review by the officers and coaching staff.
- **Resource Integrity:** Material hogging, hiding tools, or monopolizing builds/supplies designated for specific build or lab events is strictly forbidden. The team succeeds together, and all club-purchased materials are whole-team property.
- **Purchases:** All purchases must go through the Treasurer or a Head Coach. Any purchases that were not pre-approved by a Head Coach are not eligible for reimbursement from the team.

Section 2: Voting Rights & Candidacy

- **Voting Membership:** To be recognized as a full voting member in officer and special elections, a student must be in good standing and have competed in at least one High School Science Olympiad tournament in the past season.
- **Candidacy:** A student must be an active, voting member in good standing to run for any elected officer position. In addition they must fulfill any requirements for their selected office.

ARTICLE III: ELECTED OFFICERS (THE EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE)

To prevent any single student from superseding the others, the Executive Committee functions on a consensus model. All major club decisions, except where explicitly delegated, require a majority vote of the five officers, subject to coach oversight.

Section 1: The President

- **Eligibility:** Must have competed in at least three tournaments on the main team and have their character vouched for by a coach.
- **Social & Cultural Leadership:** Serves as the public face and social leader of the club. They set team goals, inspire competitive drive, and champion the team's shared spirit.
- **Club Operations:** In charge of running weekly team meetings. They send out weekly email updates to the club and present weekly briefings during meetings (slideshow encouraged).
- **Administration Liaison:** Acts as the primary student liaison to the school administration. This includes attending any school board meetings recognizing the club.
- **Publicist Collaboration:** Works directly with the Publicist to plan monthly team-building, enrichment, and social events.

Section 2: The Vice-President (VP)

- **Eligibility:** Must have competed in at least three tournaments for ELHS.
- **Competitive Execution:** Responsible for executing the team's competitive strategy, checking logged study hours, and maintaining direct communication with event teams.
- **Captains' Director:** Acts as the direct supervisor to the appointed Test, Build, and Lab Captains. The VP ensures captains are meeting their weekly checkpoints.
- **Roster Development:** Works in tandem with the President to draft tournament rosters.
- **Line of Succession:** Steps in to assume presidential duties or assist other officers if they are absent or incapacitated. If no president is elected after an officer or special election, the VP assumes the role of President.

Section 3: The Treasurer

- **Eligibility:** Must have competed in at least two tournaments for ELHS and completed a coach-designated club administrative assessment.
- **Logistics & Orders:** Manages tournament food surveys/sign-up forms and oversees the design competition and ordering of team T-shirts/merch.
- **Financial Tracking:** Takes proposals for fund allocations, maintains clear tracking of club funds and materials, and presents formal money requests to the coaching staff. The

treasurer is the bridge between event groups and the coach for resource orders.

- **Fundraising:** Highly encouraged to initiate and oversee club fundraisers. Works directly with the Secretary and President on corporate and local business sponsorship drives.

Section 4: The Secretary

- **Eligibility:** Must have competed in at least two tournaments for ELHS and completed a coach-designated club administrative assessment.
- **Records & Communication:** Takes detailed minutes at all executive and general meetings and archives them in the Google Drive.
- **Community Outreach:** Drafts and distributes monthly newsletters/writeups to keep parents, students, and sponsors updated on club progress, tournament results, and upcoming schedules.
- **Digital Architecture:** Manages and organizes the team's Google Drive and assists the Publicist with management of other digital systems.
- **Sponsorship Coordination:** Works alongside the Treasurer and President to secure external sponsorships.

Section 5: The Publicist

- **Eligibility:** Must have competed in at least two tournaments and present a portfolio of prior digital media or design work.
- **Media Management:** Manages the team's official social media platforms (such as Instagram and YouTube) and captures or curates photos at events and tournaments. Also facilitates requests or competitions to collect pictures from team members.
- **Web Liaison:** Delivers content updates, tournament results, and team announcements to a maintainer of the official team websites (elhssoc.com and elso.win).
- **Enrichment & Culture:** Coordinates with the President to plan at least one fun club event, game, or team-building activity per month. These can include games at meetings, scavenger hunts or other excursions across the city, or organizing an end-of-year field trip (e.g., Greenfield Village).

ARTICLE IV: APPOINTED CAPTAINS

Captains are technical leadership roles appointed by the coaching staff at the start of each season. Captains do not hold executive voting rights on the committee, but they are vital to competitive operations. They report directly to the Vice-President and assigned event coaches.

Section 1: General Captain Responsibilities

- **Weekly Check-ins:** Connect with every student group within their category at least once a week to monitor progress, identify bottlenecks, and ensure partners are working cohesively.
- **Resource Tracking:** Actively manage and organize physical or digital tools, kits, bins, goggles, and reference materials assigned to their category. Request new materials through the Treasurer and head coach.
- **Academic Support:** Collect, organize, and distribute practice tests, study guides, or technical keys when applicable.

Section 2: Captain Categories

- **Test Captain:** Oversees study events (e.g., Anatomy & Physiology, Codebusters, Dynamic Planet). Focuses on resource compilation, binder organization, and timed practice test tracking.
- **Build Captain:** Oversees engineering and construction events (e.g., Bridge, Hovercraft, Wright Stuff). Focuses on workshop safety, material inventory, build log compliance, and testing scheduling.
- **Lab Captain:** Oversees hybrid lab/academic events (e.g., Chem Lab, Forensics, Optics). Focuses on lab safety compliance, equipment checks, and hands-on material practice.
- **Additional Appointments:** Other captain categories may be created and appointed by a head coach at any time with a majority approval of officers and a majority approval of coaching staff. Roles are to be clearly defined by the coaching staff at the time of creation.

ARTICLE V: COACH ROLES & AUTHORITY

While the student officers drive the day-to-day energy of the club, the adult Coaching Staff maintains ultimate structural, financial, and safety authority.

- **Tournament Logistics:** Head Coaches find, sign up, and register the club for competitive tournaments.
- **Roster Finalization:** Officers and captains may propose roster modifications, but the coaching staff retains final authority to settle roster disputes and send out official team lists.
- **Scheduling & Logistics:** Head coaches generate tournament day schedules, coordinate transportation including buses, and manage administrative communications.
- **Professional Outreach:** Coaches assist in finding specialized event mentors, including university professors, industry professionals, or college students.
- **Appointing new Coaches:** Head Coaches reserve the right to appoint or reject anyone as a coach with approval of at least two officers.
- **Infrastructure Management:** Coaches handle financial renewals for digital systems, including the Google Drive, web domains (elhssoc.com and elso.win), and other associated subscriptions.
- **Materials Orders:** Coaches handle all club transactions and must grant approval before any team member purchases an item with their own funds with the intention of reimbursement from the club.

ARTICLE VI: ELECTION TIMELINES & PROCEDURES

Section 1: Standard Officer Elections

- **Timing:** Annual elections must take place over two meetings sometime between the State Tournament and the last day of school for Seniors. If the team qualifies for the National Tournament, the window moves to the period between the National Tournament and the last day of school.
- **Method:** Voting is conducted via secret, individual ballot. Every eligible voting member receives exactly one vote per officer position.
- **Tabulation:** Ballots are audited and verified by an unbiased exiting officer or by a coach to ensure total election integrity.
- **Transfer of Power:** Exiting officers should transfer records and permissions to incoming officers. This includes an invitation to the SciOly Captains Discord server and permissions updates on the team Google Drive and Discord. Other digital accounts should also be shared with new officers including access to the club email and instagram account.

Section 2: Special Elections

- If an elected position remains open at the end of the previous school year, or if an officer resigns or is removed, a Special Election must be scheduled and held exactly two weeks into the new school year or two weeks following the resignation or removal.
- Campaign rules and voting thresholds mirror the standard officer election process unless redefined by a Head Coach.

ARTICLE VII: CONFLICT RESOLUTION & IMPEACHMENT

Section 1: Behavioral and Partner Disputes

When issues arise regarding material hogging, failure to meet with event partners, or general infractions of the team code of conduct, the following progressive discipline path applies:

1. **Peer Mediation:** The Vice-President and relevant Captain review the situation with the affected partners to re-establish expectations.
2. **Executive Hearing:** If the behavior continues, the President and Vice-President hold a private meeting with the student to establish a formal warning and performance correction plan.
3. **Coach Intervention:** If the behavior remains unresolved, the matter is escalated directly to the Coaching Staff, who reserve the right to alter tournament event assignments, move a student to an alternate status, or remove them from the club entirely.

Section 2: Officer Impeachment

Officers are expected to remain actively engaged. While they do not have to achieve perfection, prolonged, unexcused inaction or complete abandonment of duties is unacceptable.

- **Grounds for Impeachment:** Clear evidence of non-performance of duties, failure to maintain good academic standing, unauthorized use of club funds, or behavioral violations of the school code of conduct.
- **Process:** Any member or coach can bring a formal grievance to the Executive Committee. An impeachment inquiry requires a majority vote of the remaining four officers and the explicit approval of the Head Coach.
- **Resolution:** If an officer is impeached and removed, a Special Election to fill the vacant role must be organized and executed exactly two weeks following removal.

Section 3: Captain Re-Appointment

- If an appointed Captain fails to perform their duties (e.g., neglecting weekly check-ins, poor organization), they may be removed directly by a Head Coach.
- No special election is required; the coaches will simply select a qualified, active member to fill the role within two weeks of the vacancy.

ARTICLE VIII: FORBIDDEN EXECUTIVE POWERS

- **Roster Protections:** No student officer may unilaterally edit, alter, or manipulate tournament rosters without direct consultation with the Executive Committee and signature confirmation from a coach.
- **Ethics:** Bribery, blackmail, hazing, extortion, or intentional academic dishonesty (cheating) will result in immediate expulsion from the club and referral to school administration.
- **No Banning Fun:** The lighthearted tradition of the club must be preserved. While light jokes regarding team lore are part of club culture, making such themes a mandatory club requirement or completely banning harmless inside jokes is prohibited by executive consensus. Let the team stay fun!

ARTICLE IX: AMENDMENTS

These bylaws are dynamic and intended to grow with the club.

Proposed amendments must be presented in writing during an executive meeting and require a three-fifths (3/5) majority vote of the active student Executive Committee alongside final sign-off from a coach to be ratified.

Amendments may also be made without a sign-off from a coach if all five officers vote to approve an amendment.

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Amendment	
Effective Date	
Signatures	

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Amendment	
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